

ISP Report

This brief report is meant to cover what Godot elements I encountered for the first time, what areas I struggled the most with, and my plans going forward.

Before this ISP I had only gained experience with `TileMapLayer`, `Sprite2D`, `Area2D`, and the basic elements needed to be able to move my main character around the screen. During the ISP most of the systems were made up of these basic components but put together in ways I would not have thought of without watching and going through the many coding tutorials listed in my resources. The sound system was completely new to me and by far the easiest since Godot has a preconfigured node I just had to drop my sound into. The save system was the other new piece of code I had to deal with. Godot has a flexible save system that let me set up the files in the Interface > Instantiator > Information Gatherer format I've seen before in other code. But it was also the most difficult piece of code I had to work with since it spans across so many different files. There were consistent issues with ghost scripts (deleted or duplicate scripts that were cached and still influencing the code), sync problems, and just simple loading errors. For example, the inventory system had to use a helper function since it has nested information that Godot doesn't process the same way as ordinary non-nestled information. The puzzle mechanic also caused me some trouble when dealing with the save file since I had to add 2 new variables to define that yes the roly-polies can be collected and deleted separately.

That being said, I see now why it would be much easier to keep the levels linear and may have to do some alterations to my level 1 write up. I had originally planned for players return to passed levels but that may slow down the game too much and make the save file overly complicated. I also want to change the current message system to be centered in the player node so that it can be more visually consistent for the player. Doing so would also simplify the npc and paper item nodes making the engine lighter and faster when playing.

Overall, this ISP was successful. While I did not get to fully flesh out this level the basic requirements were fulfilled and I now have several systems that I can use throughout the rest of my game development.